UBUNIFU SACCO Ltd.

Company Profile

UBUNIFU SACCO Ltd. is a member-owned financial cooperative dedicated to empowering Uganda's growing ecosystem of technology startups, innovators, and creatives. Established in 2025, UBUNIFU SACCO aims to provide affordable financial services, access to startup capital, and a vibrant community network that fosters innovation, entrepreneurship, and inclusive economic growth.

The SACCO is uniquely positioned to address the financial and networking needs of youth-led enterprises, tech innovators, digital content creators, and creative professionals by offering tailored financial products and capacity-building programs. Through collaboration, trust, and a commitment to sustainable development, UBUNIFU SACCO bridges the gap between creative potential and economic opportunity.

Vision

To become the leading financial cooperative in Uganda that supports technology-driven enterprises, empowering creators and innovators to shape a better, inclusive digital economy.

Mission

To provide accessible, innovative, and inclusive financial services that support startups, creatives, and innovators in Uganda through savings, affordable credit, business development support, and strategic partnerships.

Core Services

i. **Savings and Investment Products**: Affordable savings plans, fixed deposit accounts, and investment opportunities designed to encourage a culture of financial growth among members.
ii. **Startup and Innovation Loans**: Tailored credit facilities to support early-stage tech startups, digital platforms, creative ventures, and social innovations.
iii. **Business Development Support**: Capacity-building programs, mentorship, and advisory services for members to help them scale their businesses and ideas.

iv. **Networking and Collaboration Hubs:** Creating spaces for members to connect, co-create, and access market opportunities, accelerators, and innovation labs.

v. **Digital and Financial Literacy Training**: Equipping members with essential skills in digital tools, budgeting, business planning, and investment management.

Objectives

i. To provide reliable financial support systems for startups, creatives, and technology entrepreneurs.

ii. To foster a connected and collaborative innovation ecosystem in Uganda.

iii. To promote financial literacy and digital inclusion among youth and creative communities.

iv. To build a self-sustaining SACCO model that contributes to Uganda's social and economic development.

v. To attract and manage investment capital through shares and strategic partnerships.

Contact Information

Company Name: UBUNIFU SACCO Ltd.

Contact Person: Mucunguzi Moses, SACCO Coordinator

Provisional Address: Plot 15, Mutungo Hill, Kampala, Uganda

Telephone: +256 781 940358

Email: info@ubunifusacco.org

Website: ubunifusacco.co.ug

SACCO INFORMATION

SACCO Information	Details
Project Title	Establishment and Operationalization of UBUNIFU SACCO to Support Technology Startups and Creative Enterprises in Uganda
Project Location	Entire Uganda
Project Duration	5 years (January 2026 – December 2031)
Project Objective	To establish a functional SACCO that enhances financial access, networking, and business development support for technology innovators and creatives in Uganda
Beneficiaries	Tech startups, digital entrepreneurs, innovators, creatives (artists, designers, developers), and youth-led enterprises
Budget	UGX 50,000,000,000
Funding Sources	Member contributions, private investors, government of Uganda, development partners, and innovation grant opportunities
Implementing Organization	UBUNIFU SACCO LTD

INTRODUCTION

In Uganda, technology startups, innovators, and creative enterprises continue to face persistent challenges that inhibit their potential to drive socio-economic transformation and digital inclusion. Despite a burgeoning youth population and increasing levels of digital literacy, access to affordable finance, business development services, and robust support networks remains a critical bottleneck. Most tech entrepreneurs struggle to secure early-stage capital due to underdeveloped venture financing ecosystems and high perceived risk by traditional financial institutions (Islam et al., 2018; Kato & Chiloane-tsoka, 2022). In a rapidly evolving digital economy, the absence of targeted support mechanisms leaves many high-potential startups and creatives underfunded, under-networked, and unable to scale.

Uganda's innovation ecosystem, though vibrant, is fragmented and lacks the integrated financial infrastructure needed to nurture ideas into commercially viable ventures (Jjagwe et al., 2024). Many promising initiatives fail to progress beyond pilot phases due to weak institutional support, minimal access to seed capital, and limited financial literacy among founders (Benon et al., 2024). Even where government or donor-funded innovation programs exist, the uptake is low among youth-led enterprises due to procedural bottlenecks and lack of localized access points (Nuwagaba, 2012; Atukwatse & Turyamureeba, 2024).

To bridge this gap, the establishment of UBUNIFU SACCO is both timely and strategic. Conceived as a specialized financial cooperative, UBUNIFU SACCO aims to enhance access to credit, foster business networking, and promote innovation financing for Uganda's technology and creative sectors. By aggregating resources through member contributions, shares, and external investments, the SACCO will serve as a sustainable vehicle to mobilize and channel capital into underserved but high-potential enterprises (Anania & Gikuri, 2016; Dickens et al., 2020).

In contrast to conventional SACCOs that primarily support agriculture or small trade, UBUNIFU SACCO is designed with a sector-specific lens, focusing on startups, developers, digital content creators, artists, and technologists. This strategic orientation allows for tailored financial products such as innovation loans, equipment leasing, and grant matching services, which are often absent in traditional cooperative models (Arena et al., 2017; Noelin, 2024). Furthermore, the SACCO intends to integrate digital platforms for savings, lending, and member engagement, ensuring that tech-savvy entrepreneurs can access services efficiently and remotely (Wanga, 2025).

The importance of aligning financial mechanisms with the unique needs of the innovation economy cannot be overstated. Studies have shown that access to structured and affordable finance significantly improves startup resilience and growth trajectories, particularly when complemented by mentorship and market linkages (Bjornali & Ellingsen, 2014; Kamulegeya et al., 2017). UBUNIFU SACCO will function not only as a source of capital but as a hub for collaboration; fostering partnerships among members, incubators, academia, and private investors.

Moreover, the SACCO aligns with Uganda's national development goals and innovation policies, particularly those emphasizing youth employment, digital transformation, and enterprise development (Kayongo et al., 2022). As observed in similar regional contexts, well-managed

SACCOs contribute to local economic empowerment and poverty alleviation when governance structures are transparent and member-driven (Bosco & Moses, 2023; Tukamuhebwa et al., 2022).

With an initial budget of UGX 50 billion over a 5-year period (2026–2031), UBUNIFU SACCO seeks to mobilize funding from member equity, private investors, government innovation funds, and international development partners. Its phased rollout across Uganda will prioritize areas with high concentrations of youth innovators, including urban centers, university towns, and tech incubation hubs.

Ultimately, the success of UBUNIFU SACCO will be measured not only by its financial metrics but also by its ability to unlock the potential of Uganda's next generation of innovators. By fostering a culture of savings, collaboration, and digital entrepreneurship, the SACCO promises to be a transformative institution, bridging the gap between talent and opportunity, and powering Uganda's transition into a knowledge-based economy (Adler et al., 2019; Santisteban et al., 2021).

PROBLEM STATEMENT

In Uganda, technology startups, innovators, and creative enterprises face significant barriers to growth and sustainability due to limited access to tailored financial services, weak networking platforms, and inadequate business development support. Despite the rapid expansion of the technology and creative sectors, these enterprises remain underserved by traditional financial institutions, which often perceive them as high-risk and lack customized financial products that fit their unique business models (Jjagwe, Kirabira, & Mukasa, 2024; Nuwagaba, Nyende, & Namanya, 2021). This gap constrains innovation, economic growth, and job creation within the country's increasingly digital and creative economy.

Savings and Credit Cooperative Societies (SACCOs) have historically played a pivotal role in enhancing financial inclusion in Uganda, especially among rural communities and informal sectors (Kayongo et al., 2022). However, most SACCOs focus primarily on agriculture, trade, and general small businesses, leaving the technology and creative sectors underserved due to their unique financing needs and business risks (Atukwatse & Turyamureeba, 2024; Anania & Gikuri, 2016). Additionally, existing SACCOs often lack the capacity to provide non-financial services such as networking, mentorship, and access to innovation ecosystems which are critical for technology

startups and creative entrepreneurs to thrive (Santisteban, Mauricio, & Nacional, 2021; Jjagwe, Kirabira, Mukasa, & Amanya, 2024).

The financing gap is further exacerbated by systemic challenges, including limited venture capital availability, inadequate government support, and insufficient tailored innovation grants accessible to early-stage tech startups and creatives (Kato & Chiloane-tsoka, 2022; Islam, Fremeth, & Marcus, 2018; Nakalembe et al., 2023). Traditional financial institutions often demand collateral and impose rigid lending terms that young innovators and creatives cannot meet, which results in exclusion from formal credit systems (Turyahikayo, 2015; Kowa, Turinawe, & Nalwoga, 2023). Without appropriate financing, many promising startups fail during the critical early stages of their development, curtailing Uganda's potential to become a regional hub for innovation and digital creativity (Krishna, Agrawal, & Choudhary, 2016; Croce, Guerini, & Ughetto, 2016).

Beyond financing, networking remains a major bottleneck. Tech startups and creatives in Uganda often operate in isolation with limited opportunities to collaborate, access mentors, or connect with investors, markets, and innovation hubs (Adler et al., 2019; Kamulegeya, Hebig, & Hammouda, 2017). This disconnect restricts knowledge sharing, hinders commercialization of innovations, and reduces competitiveness in both local and international markets (Bjornali & Ellingsen, 2014; Jjagwe et al., 2024). The lack of a dedicated platform for these sectors to pool resources, share risks, and access support services limits their growth prospects and scalability.

Moreover, digital entrepreneurs and creatives, many of whom are youth-led, face socio-economic challenges such as unemployment and limited access to formal financial services, which were worsened by the COVID-19 pandemic's economic impact (Katusiime, 2021; Society, 2022). Empowering these groups through financial inclusion and targeted business development services can spur economic empowerment, reduce poverty, and enhance Uganda's socio-economic transformation (Kayongo et al., 2022).

The establishment of UBUNIFU SACCO aims to fill these gaps by providing an inclusive, specialized cooperative platform designed to enhance financial access, foster networks, and deliver business development support specifically for technology startups and creative enterprises across Uganda. This SACCO will tailor its financial products to meet the needs of high-growth, innovative ventures and provide value-added services such as mentorship, capacity building, and market linkages. By leveraging member contributions, private investments, government backing,

and development partner support, UBUNIFU SACCO seeks to overcome the prevailing challenges that limit startup success and innovation commercialization (Arena et al., 2017; Nuwagaba, 2012).

If these challenges remain unaddressed, Uganda risks losing out on the vast economic and social benefits that technology and creative sectors could generate. This includes job creation, increased exports, poverty reduction, and the development of a vibrant innovation ecosystem. Hence, the UBUNIFU SACCO is an essential intervention for bridging the financing and networking gaps, unlocking Uganda's innovation potential, and contributing to sustainable development and economic resilience in the digital age.

CONCEPT NOTE

Section	Details
Project Title	Establishment and Operationalization of UBUNIFU SACCO to Support Technology Startups and Creative Enterprises in Uganda
Implementing Organization	UBUNIFU SACCO Ltd.
Contact Person	Mucunguzi Moses, Programme Manager
Project Location	National: Across Uganda, with regional chapters / branches in major innovation hubs (e.g. Kampala, Mbarara, Gulu, Mbale)
Duration	5 years (January 2026 – December 2031)
Total Budget	UGX 50,000,000,000
Project Overview / Rationale	The UBUNIFU SACCO will serve as a specialized cooperative financial and support institution for technology startups, digital innovators, and creative enterprises. It seeks to fill the gap left by traditional SACCOs and commercial banks, which often do not cater to high-risk, early-stage creative or tech ventures. The SACCO will not only provide tailored credit, savings, and investment products but also foster networks, business development support, and innovation linkages across Uganda's tech and creative sectors.
Objectives	**i.** Establish an operational SACCO infrastructure (governance, systems, branch/agent networks, digital platform) for tech and creative enterprises.

	ii. Mobilize capital through member contributions, share issuance, private investors, and grants. **iii.** Provide access to affordable credit, working capital, and innovation grants to members. **iv.** Facilitate networking, mentorship, incubation support, and market linkages. **v.** Strengthen member capacity in financial literacy, business planning, and commercialization of innovations.
Key Activities	**i.** Develop SACCO governance, bylaws, board structures, internal controls, and strategic frameworks (drawing lessons from SACCO performance in Uganda). **ii.** Build and deploy a SACCO management information system and digital channels (mobile, web) for member access . **iii.** Capital raising: membership drives, share issuance, partner engagements, grant proposals. **iv.** Design tailored financial products (microloans, seed capital, bridging finance, savings schemes) suited for creative/tech ventures **v.** Establish regional branches or agent networks in key innovation hubs. **vi.** Provide mentorship, business incubation, peer networking, pitch events, investor connections. **vii.** Train members in financial literacy, business model development, commercialization strategies. **viii.** Monitor, evaluate, and iterate services based on member feedback, performance metrics, and market conditions.
Expected Outcomes / Results	**i.** At least 50,000 members (tech and creative enterprises) enrolled. **ii.** Disbursement of loans, grants, or support to a target number of startups/creative projects. **iii.** Improved business metrics for members (revenue growth, employment, sustainability). **iv.** Enhanced connectivity across the innovation ecosystem; mentor, investor, incubator linkages. **v.** A financially viable SACCO by year 3, able to sustain operations from member revenues and returns.

Key Stakeholders	**i.**	Members (tech startups, creative enterprises, youth-led ventures)
	ii.	Board of UBUNIFU SACCO
	iii.	Government agencies (Ministry of ICT, Ministry of Finance)
	iv.	Innovation hubs, accelerators, incubators
	v.	Private investors, venture capital firms, angel networks
	vi.	Development partners and donors (local & international)
	vii.	Financial regulators, cooperative associations
Monitoring & Evaluation	**i.**	Quarterly and annual reports on membership growth, loan uptake, repayment rates, defaults, member satisfaction.
	ii.	Site visits and audits of branch/agent operations.
	iii.	Feedback mechanisms (member surveys, focus group discussions).
	iv.	Performance benchmarks against peer SACCOs and industry KPIs.
	v.	Midterm and endline evaluations to assess impact on member businesses and innovation outcomes.
Sustainability Plan	**i.**	Adopt a shareholding model so that members own equity in the SACCO, fostering commitment.
	ii.	Generate revenue from interest on loans, service fees (kept affordable), and advisory services.
	iii.	Establish prudent risk management, loan recovery policies, and reserves (drawing from SACCO best practice in Uganda) .
	iv.	Create partnerships with investors, donors, and government for co-funding and guarantee schemes.
	v.	Continuously adapt services to member needs to retain relevance and competitive advantage.
	vi.	Strengthen governance, board accountability, and oversight to maintain trust and financial stability.

Prepared by: ……. ***Approved by: ……..***

Signature: …….. ***Signature: ……....***

Date: …….. ***Date: ……....***

METHODOLOGY

Literature Review

In the evolving landscape of financial inclusion and innovation in Uganda, Savings and Credit Cooperative Organizations (SACCOs) have emerged as a vital vehicle for delivering affordable financial services to underserved populations, including entrepreneurs, rural communities, and youth-led enterprises (Nuwagaba, 2012; Kayongo et al., 2022). While SACCOs have traditionally catered to agriculture and informal trade sectors, there is a growing need to align cooperative finance models with the unique needs of technology startups, innovators, and the creative economy; sectors that are increasingly shaping Uganda's economic future (Jjagwe et al., 2024).

Studies show that Uganda's startup ecosystem has expanded significantly over the past decade, particularly in fintech, health tech, agritech, and digital creative industries (Kamulegeya et al., 2017; Kato & Chiloane-tsoka, 2022). However, the majority of startups face persistent barriers to financing, especially during the early growth stages. These barriers include limited access to venture capital, high collateral requirements from banks, and weak investor networks (Singh & Subrahmanya, 2021; Turyahikayo, 2015). As a result, many promising innovations either stagnate or collapse before achieving scale (Krishna et al., 2016).

Against this backdrop, UBUNIFU SACCO seeks to reposition cooperative financing as a sustainable support system for digital entrepreneurs and creatives. This approach is supported by literature indicating that SACCOs can become powerful tools for enterprise development when strategically designed to address the needs of specific sectors (Dickens et al., 2020). In particular, sector-specific SACCOs have the potential to offer customized loan products, capacity-building programs, and networking opportunities that align with member goals (Anania & Gikuri, 2016).

Furthermore, there is increasing recognition of the role SACCOs play in reducing youth unemployment and promoting entrepreneurship. According to Noelin (2024), innovative SACCO models in Uganda have demonstrated success in fostering inclusive financial practices and supporting marginalized groups, including young innovators and women entrepreneurs. However, these benefits are only realized when SACCOs exhibit good governance, accountability, and service delivery efficiency; factors that significantly influence member satisfaction and organizational sustainability (Benon et al., 2024; Bosco & Moses, 2023).

The integration of digital technologies into SACCO operations has also become a key trend. Studies by Wanga (2025) and Khuan et al. (2023) show that digital SACCO systems can improve access, transparency, and scalability, particularly in serving remote or tech-savvy populations. Digital transformation is critical for tech-oriented SACCOs such as UBUNIFU, not only to streamline internal operations but also to reflect the digital-first nature of their target members.

Additionally, a robust SACCO ecosystem can play a significant role in facilitating innovation ecosystems by acting as intermediaries between innovators and financial opportunities such as angel investors, government grants, and venture capital (Arena et al., 2017; Islam et al., 2018). For instance, studies by Adler et al. (2019) and Jjagwe et al. (2024) emphasize the importance of clustering and knowledge-sharing platforms in driving innovation; an area where SACCOs can provide community-based infrastructure to support peer learning, resource pooling, and co-creation.

However, concerns remain regarding the financial viability and governance of SACCOs in Uganda. Poor leadership, weak loan recovery systems, and limited member education have been cited as threats to SACCO sustainability (Kowa et al., 2023; Tukamuhebwa et al., 2022a). To overcome these challenges, UBUNIFU SACCO will adopt evidence-based practices in board accountability, digital record-keeping, and member engagement strategies, as recommended by Atukwatse & Turyamureeba (2024).

Finally, the literature suggests that successful innovation financing must also involve ecosystem-wide collaboration. Partnerships with development agencies, private investors, and government innovation programs are crucial to closing the funding gap for early-stage ventures (Croce et al., 2016; Garg & Shivam, 2017). UBUNIFU SACCO will therefore explore blended financing models and public-private partnerships to mobilize the UGX 50 billion capital needed to operationalize its programs.

In conclusion, the existing body of literature supports the strategic establishment of a tech- and innovation-focused SACCO as both timely and impactful. By integrating tailored financing, governance best practices, and technology-enabled service delivery, UBUNIFU SACCO has the potential to unlock inclusive growth and strengthen Uganda's innovation economy.

Feasibility Study

UBUNIFU SACCO aims to establish a financial cooperative society dedicated to supporting technology startups, innovators, and creatives across Uganda. This feasibility study assesses the technical, economic, and social viability of the SACCO's operations, emphasizing service delivery, network building, and consumer engagement, critical to sustaining a dynamic ecosystem for tech and creative enterprises.

Technical Feasibility: The successful operationalization of UBUNIFU SACCO depends on robust financial infrastructure and technology-enabled service delivery. Leveraging digital platforms will be essential to ensure accessibility for members dispersed throughout Uganda, including urban hubs like Kampala and rural areas where technology enterprises are emerging (Jjagwe et al., 2024). Digital financial services and mobile banking systems have proven to enhance SACCO efficiency, reduce operational costs, and increase transparency (Wanga, 2025). Furthermore, the SACCO will invest in a comprehensive management information system (MIS) that supports member savings, loan processing, and real-time reporting, which is vital to meet the demands of tech-savvy entrepreneurs (Wanga, 2025).

Integration of communication networks and online forums will facilitate networking and peer collaboration among members, fostering innovation sharing and partnerships critical for high-growth startups (Adler et al., 2019). Creating innovation hubs or co-working spaces in partnership with local incubators and innovation centers will enhance service delivery by providing members with technical support and business mentorship (Tibaingana, 2020).

Economic Feasibility: The financial model for UBUNIFU SACCO relies on diversified funding streams, including member contributions, private investors, government grants, and development partners. Uganda's SACCO sector has demonstrated resilience and growth potential, with SACCOs significantly contributing to financial inclusion and poverty reduction (Anania & Gikuri, 2016; Society, 2022). However, efficient capital mobilization and prudent loan management are critical, as challenges such as loan defaults and delayed recoveries have been reported in some SACCOs (Kowa et al., 2023).

The proposed budget of UGX 50 billion will cover capital injections, operational costs, technology infrastructure, and capacity building. Considering the demand for startup financing in Uganda,

especially among youth-led enterprises, this budget is adequate for initial SACCO scaling (Nakalembe et al., 2023). The SACCO's profitability will depend on competitive loan interest rates and flexible lending terms aligned with startup cash flows, which enhances repayment rates and member satisfaction (Atukwatse & Turyamureeba, 2024). Moreover, the SACCO will explore partnerships with venture capitalists and government innovation grants to support members' business scaling (Kato & Chiloane-tsoka, 2022).

Social Feasibility: UBUNIFU SACCO's social impact targets empowerment of youth, women, and creative entrepreneurs, groups that often face barriers in accessing finance due to lack of collateral and formal credit histories. By adopting inclusive membership policies and financial literacy programs, the SACCO will foster equitable participation and financial empowerment (Kayongo et al., 2022).

The SACCO will also address challenges common in SACCO governance, including board accountability and member engagement, which significantly affect financial performance and trust (Benon et al., 2024; Bosco & Moses, 2023). A transparent governance framework and member-centric service policies will build confidence and reduce risks of mismanagement.

Furthermore, the SACCO's focus on networking will catalyze a collaborative ecosystem where knowledge transfer and joint ventures flourish, critical for overcoming commercialization barriers faced by technology startups in Uganda (Jjagwe et al., 2024). It will also bridge gaps in the innovation ecosystem by linking members to market opportunities, technical expertise, and policy advocacy platforms (Santisteban et al., 2021).

Potential Challenges and Mitigation Measures

Operational challenges may include infrastructural limitations in rural areas, where internet connectivity and banking infrastructure are weaker (Kamulegeya et al., 2017). To mitigate this, the SACCO will implement hybrid models combining physical branches and mobile banking agents. Logistical constraints, including member outreach and education, will be managed through strategic partnerships with community organizations and tech hubs.

Financial risks such as loan defaults and liquidity shortages will be addressed by adopting rigorous credit appraisal systems, diversified loan products, and maintaining adequate reserves (Moses et

al., 2023). The SACCO will also employ continuous monitoring and evaluation to identify risks early and adjust strategies accordingly.

Needs Assessment

The establishment of UBUNIFU SACCO aims to address critical gaps in financial access, business development, and networking among technology startups, innovators, and creative enterprises across Uganda. A comprehensive needs assessment is essential to identify the unique challenges faced by this sector and to design appropriate interventions that support sustainable growth and innovation.

Despite Uganda's growing digital economy and vibrant creative industries, technology startups and creatives continue to face significant barriers related to financing, market access, and capacity building (Jjagwe et al., 2024; Kamulegeya et al., 2017). Traditional financial institutions often view startups and creatives as high-risk clients due to their limited collateral and uncertain cash flows, leading to restricted access to credit (Turyahikayo, 2015). This financing gap constrains the ability of these enterprises to scale their innovations, invest in research and development, and effectively commercialize their products and services (Santisteban et al., 2021).

The financial services currently available in Uganda, including existing Savings and Credit Cooperative Organizations (SACCOs), tend to focus on conventional sectors such as agriculture and trade, often overlooking the distinct needs of technology and creative startups (Nuwagaba, 2012; Dickens et al., 2020). Moreover, SACCOs' loan terms and recovery policies may not be well-aligned with the cash flow patterns of startups, which typically experience irregular revenues and longer development cycles before profitability (Atukwatse & Turyamureeba, 2024; Kowa et al., 2023). This misalignment further exacerbates the funding challenges faced by innovators and creative entrepreneurs.

Networking and mentorship opportunities are equally limited for tech and creative startups, which hinders knowledge exchange, collaboration, and market linkages (Adler et al., 2019; Jjagwe, Kirabira, Mukasa, & Amanya, 2024). The absence of dedicated platforms or community spaces where startups can connect with investors, mentors, and industry peers restricts their capacity to attract venture capital, government grants, and other innovation funding sources (Croce, Guerini, & Ughetto, 2016; Islam et al., 2018). Additionally, many startups struggle to navigate the complex

regulatory and infrastructural environments that impact innovation commercialization in Uganda (Jjagwe et al., 2024).

Service delivery within existing SACCOs in Uganda also poses challenges related to technological adoption and operational efficiency. Many SACCOs lack robust management information systems, which limits their ability to deliver timely and transparent services, such as loan disbursements, savings management, and member communications (Wanga, 2025; Noelin, 2024). For technology startups and creatives who are often tech-savvy, there is a strong demand for digital financial services that offer convenience, speed, and transparency (Khuan, Andriani, & Rukmana, 2023). Without such innovations, SACCOs risk losing relevance among younger, technology-driven entrepreneurs.

Additionally, there are geographic disparities in financial access and startup support across Uganda. While Kampala and other urban centers have relatively more developed entrepreneurial ecosystems, many regions lack sufficient infrastructure, market access, and business support services (Harald & Lie, 2015; Jjagwe et al., 2024). UBUNIFU SACCO must therefore address the needs of startups in both metropolitan and underserved areas to foster inclusive innovation and economic growth.

Women-led startups and youth enterprises face additional barriers related to limited collateral, cultural biases, and lower levels of financial literacy, necessitating tailored interventions (Society, 2022; Kayongo et al., 2022). Empowering these groups through targeted financial products, training, and networking will be vital for equitable development.

Stakeholder Analysis

The successful establishment and operationalization of UBUNIFU SACCO will depend on the effective identification, engagement, and collaboration with key stakeholders across Uganda's innovation and financial ecosystems. These stakeholders represent diverse interests, resources, and influence, and their roles are central to the SACCO's long-term sustainability and impact.

i. **Government and Regulatory Authorities:** Government institutions such as the Ministry of Trade, Industry and Cooperatives, the Uganda Microfinance Regulatory Authority (UMRA), and the Uganda Registration Services Bureau (URSB) play a crucial role in the legal recognition, licensing, and oversight of SACCO operations. Their guidance will be

essential to ensure regulatory compliance, policy alignment, and access to government incentives for cooperative societies and startups (Kayongo et al., 2022; Katusiime, 2021).

ii. **Tech Startups, Innovators, and Creatives:** These are the primary beneficiaries and members of the SACCO. Their participation will shape the product offerings, governance, and service delivery mechanisms of UBUNIFU. By involving members early in product design and implementation, the SACCO can ensure its services are responsive to their financial needs, business cycles, and growth aspirations (Jjagwe et al., 2024; Anania & Gikuri, 2016).

iii. **Development Partners and Donor Agencies:** Entities such as the Embassy of Japan, innovation-focused NGOs, and development finance institutions are critical for providing seed capital, capacity-building support, and strategic partnerships. Their involvement strengthens the SACCO's financial foundation and enhances access to technical expertise (Harald & Lie, 2015).

iv. **Private Sector and Venture Capitalists:** Private investors, angel networks, and venture capital firms are potential co-financiers and collaborators. These actors can help bridge funding gaps and provide mentorship and market access to SACCO members (Kato & Chiloane-tsoka, 2022; Croce et al., 2016). Their support will be vital in scaling innovative ventures and connecting startups to global markets.

v. **Academic Institutions and Innovation Hubs:** Universities and innovation hubs across Uganda serve as incubators for emerging tech talent. Partnerships with these institutions can facilitate member recruitment, training, research collaboration, and access to pre-commercialized innovations (Tibaingana, 2020; Kamulegeya et al., 2017).

vi. **SACCO Sector Experts and Cooperatives:** Existing SACCOs and cooperative unions will be engaged to share best practices in governance, member engagement, and technology adoption. Their experience in SACCO management is invaluable for avoiding pitfalls and ensuring financial sustainability (Noelin, 2024; Benon et al., 2024).

Stakeholder engagement will be continuous, participatory, and transparent. UBUNIFU SACCO will establish feedback loops, stakeholder forums, and co-design sessions to ensure that stakeholder voices are integrated into decision-making processes. This inclusive approach will enhance ownership, accountability, and alignment of the SACCO's services with the real needs of its diverse user base.

Research & Data Collection

The research and data collection phase for the establishment and operationalization of UBUNIFU SACCO will employ both qualitative and quantitative methodologies to comprehensively understand the financial, networking, and business development needs of technology startups, innovators, and creative enterprises across Uganda. The goal is to gather actionable data that informs SACCO service design, improves outreach, and fosters sustainable growth among beneficiaries.

i. Surveys: A structured survey questionnaire will be distributed to a representative sample of tech startups, digital entrepreneurs, creative professionals (including artists, designers, and developers), and youth-led enterprises in urban and rural settings. The survey will collect quantitative data on key indicators such as current access to finance, preferred SACCO services, challenges faced in accessing credit, networking needs, and business growth barriers. It will also assess awareness of financial literacy, technology adoption, and readiness to participate in cooperative financial models. This approach aligns with previous findings emphasizing the importance of understanding microfinance outreach and financial inclusion in Uganda (Dickens et al., 2020).

ii. Focus Group Discussions (FGDs): FGDs will be conducted with various stakeholder groups, including tech startup founders, creative entrepreneurs, SACCO members, potential investors, and government representatives. These discussions aim to explore the nuanced challenges of service delivery, collaboration opportunities, and consumer preferences within the SACCO framework. Insights gained from FGDs will shed light on the socio-cultural and infrastructural constraints affecting SACCO uptake among innovators and creatives (Jjagwe et al., 2024; Kayongo et al., 2022). Special emphasis will be placed on identifying ways to leverage technology to enhance service delivery and build strong innovation networks (Arena et al., 2017; Khuan et al., 2023).

iii. Sampling Method: A stratified random sampling technique will be employed to ensure diverse representation of startups and creative enterprises from different regions of Uganda, including both urban tech hubs like Kampala and rural innovation centers. The strata will be based on enterprise size, sector (technology vs. creative industries), and stage of business development. This method guarantees inclusivity across age, gender, and socio-economic status, providing statistically reliable data to inform SACCO policies (Salami et al., 2014; Anania & Gikuri, 2016). Sample sizes

will be calculated using population data from national startup registries and creative sector associations.

iv. Verification of Participants: Participants will be verified through collaboration with local innovation hubs, startup incubators, cooperative unions, and community leaders to confirm their eligibility and authenticity as active innovators or creatives. This step ensures accurate representation and prevents sample bias, thereby enhancing the validity of the findings (Benon et al., 2024; Tukamuhebwa et al., 2022). Verification also includes ensuring participants are willing to engage in SACCO activities and share financial information confidentially, critical for the design of appropriate SACCO products.

v. Key Data Points to be Collected:

- Financial Needs and Challenges: Data on access to credit, preferred loan terms, savings habits, and risk tolerance (Atukwatse & Turyamureeba, 2024; Kowa et al., 2023).
- Service Delivery Preferences: Insights into desired SACCO services such as digital banking, mentorship programs, and business incubation support (Wanga, 2025; Santisteban et al., 2021).
- Networking and Collaboration: Information on current networks, barriers to collaboration, and interest in SACCO-facilitated partnerships (Adler et al., 2019; Jjagwe et al., 2024).
- Consumer Behavior: Preferences regarding SACCO shareholding, dividend expectations, and attitudes towards cooperative governance (Anania & Gikuri, 2016; Moses et al., 2023).
- Technological Adoption: Levels of digital literacy and technology use in business operations (Kamulegeya et al., 2017; Khuan et al., 2023).

vi. Data Analysis: Quantitative data will be analyzed using statistical software to identify trends, correlations, and gaps in service provision, while qualitative data from FGDs will be coded and thematically analyzed to uncover deeper insights into community needs and systemic challenges (Bjornali & Ellingsen, 2014; Nuwagaba et al., 2021). This mixed-methods approach will provide a holistic understanding of the SACCO's potential impact and guide tailored service delivery models.

vii. Expected Outcomes: The research will produce a detailed needs assessment and market analysis report that informs the operational framework of UBUNIFU SACCO. It will

highlight critical factors affecting SACCO uptake among tech startups and creatives, identify opportunities for innovative financial products, and recommend strategies for effective service delivery, member engagement, and sustainability (Noelin, 2024; Turyahikayo, 2015).

Implementation of the SACCO

The implementation of UBUNIFU SACCO will follow a phased, systematic approach designed to ensure sustainable financial services tailored to technology startups, innovators, and creatives across Uganda. This process will emphasize enhancing financial access, networking opportunities, and business development support over the project duration of five years (January 2026 – December 2031) as shown below.

i. **Needs Assessment and Stakeholder Engagement:** The initial phase will involve comprehensive needs assessments and stakeholder analysis to identify the unique financial, networking, and business development needs of tech startups, creatives, and youth-led enterprises (Jjagwe et al., 2024). Surveys, focus group discussions, and interviews will be conducted across key innovation hubs and creative communities nationwide. Stakeholders including government bodies, private investors, development partners, and SACCO members will be engaged to align the SACCO's services with sectoral demands (Anania & Gikuri, 2016).

ii. **Institutional Framework and Governance Setup:** UBUNIFU SACCO will establish a robust governance framework guided by cooperative principles and best practices in SACCO management to ensure accountability and member trust (Benon et al., 2024; Tukamuhebwa et al., 2022b). A Board of Directors comprising representatives from member categories will be elected. The governance structure will promote transparency, prudent financial management, and strategic oversight, critical for long-term viability (Bosco & Moses, 2023).

iii. **Product and Service Design:** Tailored financial products including savings schemes, startup loans, equity shares, and innovation grants will be developed based on the assessed needs of technology and creative enterprises (Nuwagaba, 2012; Arena et al., 2017). Additionally, non-financial services such as business development advisory, mentorship programs, and access to networks and incubation platforms will be integrated to foster

innovation commercialization and startup growth (Tibaingana, 2020; Jjagwe et al., 2024). The SACCO will leverage digital platforms to streamline loan applications, savings management, and member communication to enhance accessibility and efficiency (Wanga, 2025).

iv. **Capital Mobilization and Funding:** The SACCO will mobilize startup capital through multiple channels: member share contributions, private investors, government grants, and partnerships with development agencies focused on innovation financing. Fundraising campaigns and investor engagement forums will be organized to attract initial and ongoing capital (Garg & Shivam, 2017; Croce et al., 2016). Transparent financial reporting will build confidence among stakeholders, encouraging further investment and membership growth (Kato & Chiloane-tsoka, 2022).

v. **Infrastructure Development and Digital Systems:** To support efficient service delivery, UBUNIFU SACCO will develop a scalable digital management system for savings and credit operations (Wanga, 2025). This will include an integrated SACCO management information system (MIS) enabling real-time transaction tracking, loan monitoring, and member engagement. The digital infrastructure will also facilitate remote access, particularly important for startups in rural or underserved areas, thus expanding the SACCO's outreach and impact (Adler et al., 2019).

vi. **Capacity Building and Member Education:** Sustained capacity building programs will be implemented to enhance financial literacy, cooperative governance knowledge, and entrepreneurial skills among members (Kamulegeya et al., 2017). Training will include loan management, digital finance tools, business planning, and innovation commercialization strategies (Santisteban et al., 2021). Empowering members with these skills will reduce loan default risks and increase the overall success rates of supported enterprises (Atukwatse & Turyamureeba, 2024).

vii. **Service Delivery and Network Facilitation:** UBUNIFU SACCO will actively foster networks between technology startups, creatives, investors, and service providers to encourage collaboration, knowledge exchange, and market access (Anania & Gikuri, 2016; Jjagwe et al., 2024). Regular forums, innovation expos, and mentorship sessions will be organized to strengthen these linkages. Additionally, partnerships with incubators,

accelerators, and financial institutions will be pursued to broaden the range of services available to members (Tibaingana, 2020).

viii. **Monitoring, Evaluation, and Continuous Improvement:** An ongoing monitoring and evaluation (M&E) framework will be established to track progress against key performance indicators such as membership growth, loan recovery rates, financial performance, and member satisfaction (Moses et al., 2023; Noelin, 2024). Feedback mechanisms will be embedded to capture member input and respond to emerging challenges or opportunities. This adaptive approach will ensure the SACCO remains responsive and evolves with the changing needs of Uganda's innovation ecosystem (Krishna et al., 2016).

Deliverables

The key deliverables for the establishment and operationalization of UBUNIFU SACCO will include the following:

i. **Comprehensive Project Implementation Plan:** A detailed roadmap outlining phases, timelines, responsibilities, and key milestones to guide the establishment and operationalization of the SACCO, ensuring alignment with member needs and regulatory requirements (Anania & Gikuri, 2016; Moses et al., 2023).

ii. **Needs Assessment and Stakeholder Analysis Report:** A report based on extensive consultations with tech startups, innovators, creatives, and youth enterprises to identify financial and non-financial service gaps, as well as opportunities for networking and business support (Jjagwe et al., 2024; Dickens et al., 2020).

iii. **Feasibility Study and Market Analysis:** A comprehensive study evaluating the economic viability, potential risks, and opportunities within Uganda's tech and creative sectors, including an analysis of member preferences and competition (Kamulegeya et al., 2017).

iv. **SACCO Financial Products and Service Portfolio:** Development and documentation of tailored financial services such as savings schemes, flexible loans, and investment opportunities designed to meet the unique needs of technology startups and creative entrepreneurs (Atukwatse & Turyamureeba, 2024; Nuwagaba et al., 2021).

v. **Technology-Enabled Service Delivery Platform:** Deployment of a SACCO Management Information System (MIS) to facilitate digital transactions, member account management,

and efficient service delivery, enhancing accessibility and transparency (Wanga, 2025; Kayongo et al., 2022).

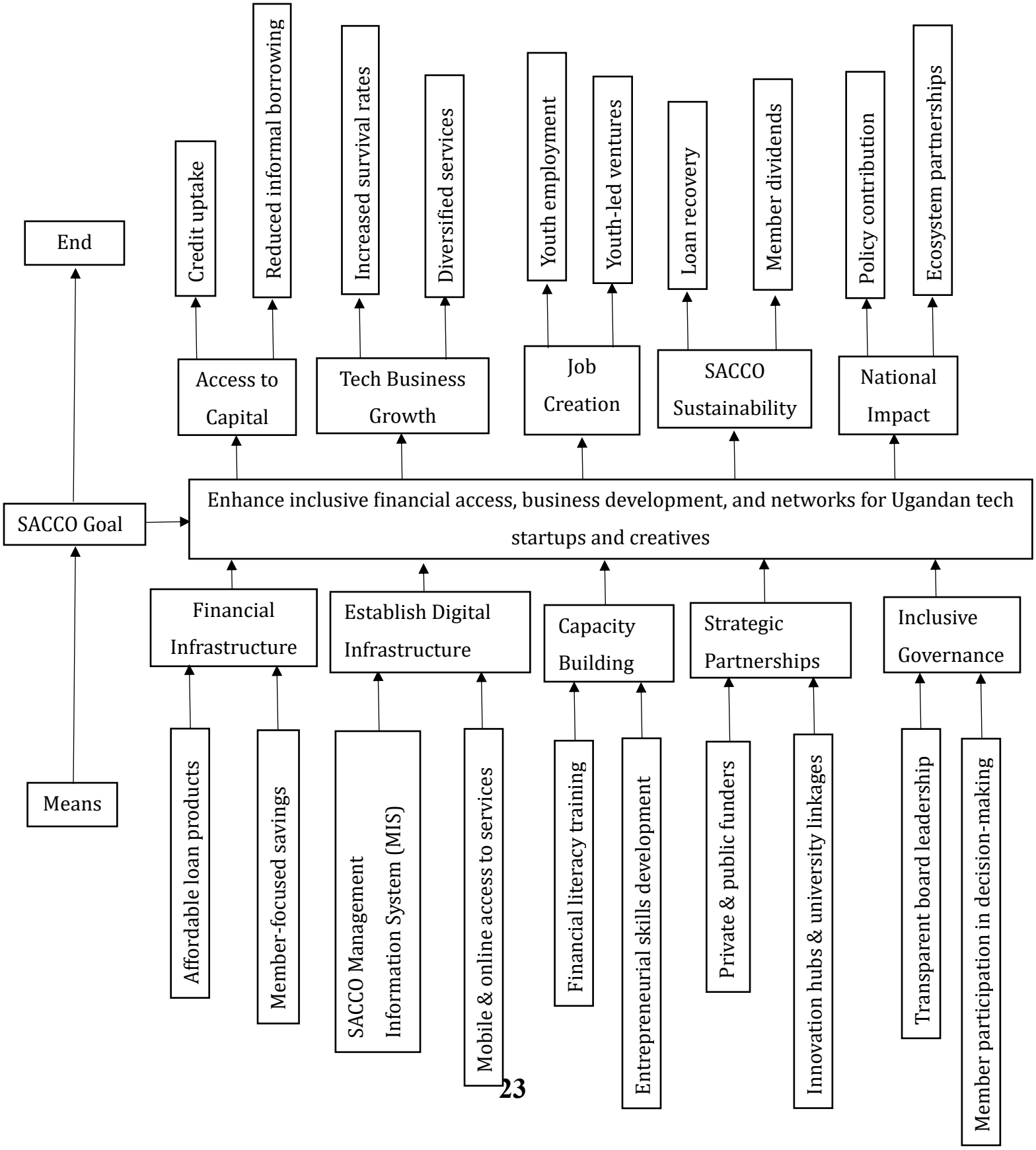
vi. **Capacity Building and Networking Programs:** Training materials and records from workshops aimed at enhancing entrepreneurial skills, financial literacy, and collaboration among SACCO members to foster innovation and growth (Santisteban et al., 2021; Tibaingana, 2020).

vii. **Quarterly and Annual Progress Reports:** Periodic reports detailing financial performance, membership growth, service uptake, challenges encountered, and corrective measures to maintain accountability and transparency (Benon et al., 2024; Bosco & Moses, 2023).

viii. **Final Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Report:** An end-of-project report summarizing achievements, impact on beneficiaries, sustainability strategies, and recommendations for scaling and replication in other regions (Noelin, 2024; Kayongo et al., 2022).

All deliverables will be shared with stakeholders, including members, government agencies, development partners, and innovation hubs, to foster trust and collaborative growth within Uganda's entrepreneurial ecosystem.

OBJECTIVES OF THE SACCO



SACCO BENEFICIARY SPECIFICATION

Beneficiary Category	Description	Potential Needs	UBUNIFU SACCO Service Alignment
Tech Startups	Early-stage companies leveraging technology to solve problems	Seed capital, business incubation, networks, market access	Affordable credit, innovation grants, business advisory, networking forums
Digital Entrepreneurs	Individuals or SMEs offering digital products or services	Working capital, digital marketing support, platform development	Loans, digital platform partnerships, e-commerce training
Software Developers	Freelancers or companies building apps, websites, and custom tech solutions	Access to devices, software licenses, cloud hosting, collaboration networks	Asset financing, bulk licensing programs, tech community hubs
Creative Industry Workers	Artists, designers, filmmakers, musicians, and content creators	Equipment, content monetization, digital distribution, intellectual property training	Creative-specific loan packages, copyright education, digital marketplaces
Innovators/Inventors	Individuals or groups developing new products, systems, or methods	Prototype funding, IP support, commercialization pathways	Innovation funds, legal advisory for patents, technical mentorship
Youth-led Enterprises	Businesses owned and managed by young entrepreneurs (<35 years)	Startup capital, mentorship, peer learning, exposure to innovation ecosystems	Youth-specific loan schemes, mentorship programs, innovation challenges
Women in Tech & Innovation	Female entrepreneurs and creatives in STEM, ICT, and innovation	Gender-inclusive funding, safe networking spaces, mentorship	Women empowerment funds, gender-sensitive policies, mentorship

Tech Hubs & Incubators	Organizations offering incubation, co-working, and acceleration services	Partner support, funding for incubates, co-financing	Strategic partnerships, shared resource facilities, joint programs
Freelancers/Gig Workers	Independent tech and creative professionals working per project	Short-term loans, savings solutions, social security	Micro-loans, savings plans, health & pension products
Academic Innovators	Students and researchers creating tech and creative innovations	Funding for research prototypes, commercialization support	Research commercialization funds, university-SACCO partnerships
Diaspora Returnees	Ugandans returning from abroad with tech and innovation experience	Re-integration support, access to finance, legal/market guidance	Diaspora investment schemes, SACCO-backed startup support
Rural Tech Creatives	Innovators and creatives operating in rural or underserved areas	Access to ICT infrastructure, finance, market linkages	Rural innovation programs, mobile SACCO services, solar tech financing
SMEs in ICT/Creative Sector	Small and medium-sized enterprises in tech-enabled or creative businesses	Scale-up capital, access to skilled labor, systems improvement	SACCO enterprise loans, HR training partnerships, automation support
Investors/Shareholders	Individuals and institutions seeking to invest in the innovation ecosystem	Transparent structures, return on investment, impact opportunities	Share acquisition, dividends, stakeholder engagement forums
Government and NGOs	Public and development sector institutions supporting innovation & youth	Collaboration partners for policy, funding, implementation	Public-private partnerships, policy advocacy, program co-implementation

SACCO BUSINESS MODEL DEVELOPMENT

Component	Description
1. Value Proposition	**i.** Affordable and tailored financial services for tech startups, innovators, and creatives **ii.** Business development support (training, incubation, mentoring) **iii.** Access to innovation grants and venture funding **iv.** Digital platforms for seamless service delivery **v.** Networking and collaboration hubs for creatives and technologists
2. Customer Segments	**i.** Tech startups **ii.** Innovators and inventors **iii.** Digital entrepreneurs **iv.** Youth-led creative enterprises **v.** Freelancers in digital, design, and content industries
3. Channels	**i.** Digital SACCO platforms (web/app) **ii.** Innovation hubs and co-working spaces **iii.** Partner tech incubators and universities **iv.** Community outreach and tech events
4. Customer Relationships	**i.** Member-based ownership and governance **ii.** Tech-enabled self-service platforms **iii.** Personalized support through SACCO agents and mentors **iv.** Online communities and feedback loops
5. Revenue Streams	**i.** Member registration and subscription fees **ii.** Interest from startup and SME loans **iii.** Investment in tech ventures **iv.** Commission from value-added services (training, certification, grants, etc.) **v.** Government and donor grants
6. Key Activities	**i.** Lending to startups and creatives **ii.** Capacity building and incubation programs **iii.** Establishing innovation-support networks **iv.** Mobilizing savings and investments

	v. Partner and donor engagement **vi.** Digital service platform development
7. Key Resources	**i.** Member capital and shares **ii.** Innovation-driven staff and leadership **iii.** ICT infrastructure (MIS, mobile apps) **iv.** Strategic partnerships (accelerators, tech hubs, universities) **v.** Regulatory licenses from Uganda's cooperative authorities
8. Key Partners	**i.** Ministry of ICT and National Guidance **ii.** Uganda Cooperative Savings and Credit Union (UCSCU) **iii.** Tech incubators (e.g., Hive Colab, Outbox) **iv.** Universities and research institutions **v.** Development partners (UNCDF, GIZ, etc.) **vi.** Venture capital firms and angel investors
9. Cost Structure	**i.** Tech platform development and maintenance **ii.** Operational and administrative costs **iii.** Capacity building and member training **iv.** Marketing and outreach **v.** Loan loss provisions and risk management
10. Impact Metrics	**i.** Number of tech startups funded **ii.** Loan repayment rate and portfolio health **iii.** Member satisfaction and retention **iv.** Youth employment generated **v.** Number of digital solutions commercialized
11. Innovation Integration	**i.** Use of blockchain for transparent transactions **ii.** AI-based credit scoring for startups **iii.** Crowdfunding integration for startups **iv.** Partnerships with fintechs for alternative lending models
12. Sustainability Strategy	**i.** Blending commercial returns with social impact **ii.** Leveraging public-private partnerships **iii.** Diversified income streams **iv.** Strong governance and accountability systems

SACCO STRATEGY AND EXPECTED RESULTS OF THE SACCO

Strategy Overview

The core strategy of UBUNIFU SACCO is to establish a financial and support ecosystem specifically tailored for technology startups, innovators, and creatives across Uganda. This SACCO will act not only as a financing vehicle but also as a catalyst for digital inclusion, innovation commercialization, and enterprise sustainability.

By leveraging a member-driven model, UBUNIFU SACCO aims to provide tailored financial services, foster networking and incubation spaces, and support enterprise development through digital platforms. The SACCO will also emphasize good governance, digital transformation, and partnership development to scale its reach and impact.

Strategic Pillars

i. **Financial Access for Tech Innovators:** UBUNIFU SACCO will offer low-interest, flexible loan products, savings plans, and investment opportunities tailored to the lifecycle of tech and creative startups. These financial products will be designed to support ideation, prototyping, market entry, and scaling. This approach aligns with studies such as that by Atukwatse and Turyamureeba (2024), which emphasize that customized lending models can enhance profitability and sustainability in SACCOs.

ii. **Digital Service Delivery:** A core component of the strategy is the deployment of a mobile-first SACCO Management Information System (MIS) that allows members to access services via web, USSD, and mobile apps. Wanga (2025) highlights the critical role of technology in SACCO operations, enhancing both transparency and operational efficiency. The MIS will integrate digital wallets, instant loan applications, peer-to-peer payments, and e-statements, thus ensuring inclusivity for both urban and rural innovators.

iii. **Capacity Building and Enterprise Development:** UBUNIFU SACCO will collaborate with tech hubs, universities, and development organizations to offer financial literacy, innovation bootcamps, and business development training. Tibaingana (2020) notes the transformative role of incubation in scaling startups, especially in the Ugandan context. These capacity-building initiatives will be tailored to bridge knowledge gaps in business strategy, pitching, fundraising, intellectual property, and digital marketing.

iv. **Collaborative Networks and Partnerships:** To achieve systemic impact, UBUNIFU SACCO will forge partnerships with government agencies (such as the Ministry of ICT and Innovation), private investors, development partners, and venture capitalists. Adler et al. (2019) highlight the role of spatial and relational networks in enhancing startup performance. By integrating SACCO activities into broader entrepreneurial ecosystems, members will gain access to markets, mentorship, and investor matchmaking opportunities.

v. **Governance and Transparency:** Governance structures will be built on cooperative principles, digital audit trails, and participatory decision-making. Bosco and Moses (2023) demonstrate that effective corporate governance enhances performance in Ugandan SACCOs. Regular audits, member forums, and digital reporting will strengthen transparency and build stakeholder confidence.

Expected Results

By the end of the five-year period, UBUNIFU SACCO expects to achieve the following outcomes:

i. **Enhanced Financial Inclusion:** Enroll over 25,000 members, including youth-led startups, women in tech, and rural creatives, reducing the financial exclusion gap among innovative enterprises.

ii. **Capital Mobilization and Growth:** Mobilize UGX 50 billion in member savings, share capital, and external investments, fueling loan disbursements and infrastructure development.

iii. **Support for Innovation Commercialization:** Provide financing and incubation support to at least 3,000 tech-driven micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs), aiding in commercialization and scale. Jjagwe et al. (2024) emphasize the systemic challenges to innovation commercialization; UBUNIFU will offer a streamlined path through financial and non-financial services.

iv. **Job Creation and Economic Empowerment:** Indirectly create over 10,000 jobs through member enterprises in sectors like fintech, digital media, design, agritech, and e-commerce, aligning with the findings of Arena et al. (2017) on the potential of social tech startups in emerging economies.

v. **Improved SACCO Performance Metrics:** Maintain a loan repayment rate above 90% and operational self-sufficiency by year three, supported by proper loan recovery systems and financial risk management (Kowa et al., 2023).

vi. **Strengthened Innovation Ecosystem:** Establish strong partnerships with at least 15 innovation stakeholders, from hubs to funders, creating a collaborative pipeline from idea to scale.

SACCO STAKEHOLDERS ANALYSIS

Stakeholder	Category	Interests	Roles	Level of Influence
Tech Startups & Creatives (members)	Primary Beneficiaries	Access to affordable finance, networking, mentorship, growth support	Core SACCO members, loan applicants, contributors	High
Government of Uganda (Ministry of Trade, Ministry of ICT)	Policy Maker / Development Partner	Economic growth, youth employment, digital transformation	Regulator, funding support, policy alignment	High
Private Investors & Angel Networks	Capital Provider	Return on investment, innovation exposure, social impact	Provide equity investments, innovation funding	High
Development Partners (e.g., UNDP, GIZ, World Bank)	Development Funders	Inclusive growth, innovation, SDG alignment	Grant funding, technical support	Medium to High
Financial Institutions (Banks, MFIs)	Financial Stakeholder	Portfolio expansion, co-investment, fintech partnerships	Provide co-financing, technology partnerships	Medium
Innovation Hubs & Incubators (e.g., Innovation Village, Hive Colab)	Technical Partners	Entrepreneur support, startup pipeline growth	Provide mentorship, training, referrals	Medium

Board of Directors	Internal Governance	Organizational success, accountability, transparency	Strategic oversight, decision-making, policy development	High
SACCO Staff and Management	Internal Operational	Job security, performance incentives, impact	Implement services, manage finances, customer care	High
Regulators (UCSCU, UCC, Bank of Uganda)	Regulatory	Compliance, sector integrity, financial oversight	Licensing, supervision, policy enforcement	Medium to High
Youth-Led Enterprises & University Graduates	Target Beneficiaries	Financial inclusion, skill development, market access	SACCO members, innovators, borrowers	Medium
ICT Solution Providers (Fintechs, developers)	Service Providers	Business expansion, innovation testing, partnerships	Build SACCO MIS, mobile apps, integration systems	Medium
Local Government (Districts, Urban Councils)	Local Stakeholder	Local economic development, employment creation	Mobilize community support, promote SACCO services	Medium
Community-Based Organizations (CBOs) & NGOs	Community Partners	Capacity building, community impact, economic inclusion	Mobilize grassroots innovators, outreach	Low to Medium
Media & Communication Channels	Public Engagement	Content generation, tech promotion, brand association	Disseminate information, promote visibility	Low to Medium
Educational & Research Institutions	Knowledge Stakeholders	Research funding, entrepreneurship education	Link innovators, provide training & mentorship	Medium
Existing SACCOS & Cooperatives	Sector Peers	Best practices, partnerships, sustainability	Benchmarking, cooperative development	Low to Medium

RISK MANAGEMENT PLAN

Risk Description	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Measures	Responsible Party
1. **Loan default by startup members**	Financial	High	High	- Conduct strict credit assessments - Offer financial literacy training - Establish guarantor systems	Credit Committee, SACCO Management
2. **Inadequate digital infrastructure or system failure (MIS/FinTech tools)**	Technological	Medium	High	- Partner with reliable IT service providers - Regular system audits - Have a backup & disaster recovery plan	IT Department, MIS Vendor
3. **Fraud or internal financial mismanagement**	Governance	Medium	High	- Implement internal audit systems - Segregation of duties - Board oversight	Board of Directors, Internal Audit Unit
4. **Low member recruitment or retention**	Operational	Medium	Medium	- Aggressive awareness campaigns - Incentives for early members - Offer competitive services	Marketing Department, SACCO Management
5. **Regulatory non-compliance (UMRA, URSB, UCA)**	Legal/Compliance	Low	High	- Regular compliance audits - Continuous engagement with regulators - Legal support	Legal & Compliance Officer
6. **Inability to raise initial capital or attract investors**	Financial/Funding	Medium	High	- Develop attractive investment packages - Showcase ROI & impact - Partner with angel investors	Fundraising Team, Board of Directors

7. **Political interference or instability**	External/Environmental	Low	High	- Maintain neutrality - Engage all stakeholders inclusively - Diversify regional operations	Board of Directors
8. **Cybersecurity threats (hacking, data breach)**	Technological	Medium	High	- Adopt encryption & security protocols - Conduct penetration tests - Train staff on cyber hygiene	IT Department
9. **Lack of business acumen among members/startups**	Capacity/Operational	High	Medium	- Continuous capacity-building - Mentorship & incubation support	Training Unit, Innovation Partners
10. **Competition from other SACCOs or financial institutions**	Strategic/Market	Medium	Medium	- Define unique SACCO value proposition - Focus on niche (tech & creatives) - Collaborate where possible	SACCO Strategy Team
11. **Delays in government support or funding disbursements**	Funding/External	Medium	Medium	- Diversify funding sources - Establish MoUs/agreements with clear timelines	Board of Directors, Government Liaison
12. **Resistance to innovation or digital service adoption by members**	Technological/Change	Medium	Medium	- User training on digital tools - Provide hybrid services (digital & physical)	IT Dept., Member Services
13. **Inadequate board oversight or poor governance**	Governance	Low	High	- Board training - Regular performance reviews - Independent evaluation committees	Board Chairperson, Supervisory Committee

14. **Macroeconomic shocks (inflation, interest rate fluctuations)**	External/Economic	Medium	High	- Monitor market trends - Adjust loan interest rates accordingly - Build reserves	SACCO Treasury, Board Finance Committee
15. **Negative public perception or loss of trust**	Reputational	Low	High	- Transparent communication - Timely member engagement - Address complaints promptly	Communications Dept., Board of Directors

SACCO IMPLEMENTATION AND MANAGEMENT

Beneficiary Definition

The **primary beneficiaries** of UBUNIFU SACCO are technology startups, creative entrepreneurs, digital innovators, and youth-led enterprises in Uganda. This includes mobile and web developers, digital artists, software engineers, AI/robotics startups, Agri-tech ventures, creatives (graphic designers, filmmakers, content creators), and tech-enabled service providers. These groups often face barriers in accessing startup capital, financial services, strategic partnerships, and markets, particularly in underserved regions outside Kampala. UBUNIFU SACCO aims to bridge this gap by providing inclusive financial solutions, business development services, and networking opportunities.

Secondary beneficiaries include academic institutions, incubators, co-working spaces, innovation hubs, and freelance communities that serve or partner with these entrepreneurs. Through collaboration, UBUNIFU SACCO will create a vibrant innovation ecosystem that supports knowledge sharing, mentorship, and joint ventures.

SACCO Activities

i. **SACCO Legal Formation and Regulatory Compliance:** Establish UBUNIFU SACCO as a legally recognized cooperative in Uganda under the Ministry of Trade, Industry and Cooperatives and the Uganda Microfinance Regulatory Authority (UMRA).

ii. **Digital SACCO Platform Development:** Design and deploy a custom SACCO Management Information System (MIS) and mobile/web platforms to manage shares, savings, loans, and member services efficiently.

iii. **Member Recruitment and Onboarding Campaign:** Launch nationwide campaigns targeting youth innovators and creative entrepreneurs to enroll as SACCO members. Onboard members through both physical offices and digital portals.

iv. **Innovative Financial Products Design:** Develop tech-specific loan products, equity-based investment options, and innovation-focused savings plans (e.g., development loans, pre-seed loans, equipment leasing plans).

v. **Partnership Development and Fundraising:** Engage with the Government of Uganda, development partners, private investors, diaspora networks, and impact funders to raise capital and co-invest in high-potential ventures.

vi. **Innovation and Startup Mentorship Programs:** Design mentorship and acceleration programs in collaboration with universities, tech hubs, and innovation centers, focusing on business modeling, financial literacy, and investor readiness.

vii. **Networking and Innovation Events:** Host tech expos, pitch competitions, networking mixers, and regional startup showcases to foster community, partnerships, and visibility for SACCO members.

viii. **Financial Literacy and Business Development Training:** Provide regular trainings to enhance member capacity in business planning, digital marketing, bookkeeping, and tax compliance.

ix. **Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E):** Establish a robust M&E system to track key indicators like member growth, loan repayment rates, startup survival rates, and social impact metrics.

x. **Policy Advocacy and Stakeholder Engagement:** Engage with government ministries, parliamentarians, and sector regulators to advocate for enabling policies for tech SACCOS, digital finance, and startup support.

Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

1. SACCO Legal Formation and Regulatory Compliance

i. Draft and approve SACCO by-laws
ii. Register with relevant national authorities
iii. Open institutional bank accounts
iv. Establish governance structures (Board, Credit Committee, Supervisory Committee)
v. Establish countrywide branches

2. Digital SACCO Platform Development

i. Procure and customize a SACCO MIS platform
ii. Develop mobile/web interface for users
iii. Integrate mobile money and online banking systems
iv. Conduct staff and member training on system use

3. Member Recruitment and Onboarding

i. Design a branding and recruitment strategy
ii. Partner with universities, hubs, and associations for outreach
iii. Facilitate physical and digital registration of members
iv. Issue member IDs and share certificates

4. Financial Products Design

i. Conduct market needs assessments
ii. Co-create products with early members
iii. Launch loan packages for prototyping, and business scaling
iv. Set competitive interest rates and repayment schedules

5. Partnership Development and Fundraising

i. Identify potential funding partners
ii. Develop investment proposal documents
iii. Host donor/investor roundtables and forums
iv. Apply for innovation and cooperative grants

6. Mentorship and Acceleration Programs

i. Develop a mentorship curriculum
ii. Enroll mentors from tech industry and academia
iii. Match startups with mentors based on industry
iv. Monitor and report progress of mentored ventures

7. Networking and Innovation Events

i. Organize quarterly SACCO tech summits
ii. Host national pitch days and demo showcases
iii. Create partnerships with media for event visibility
iv. Recognize top-performing startups and creatives

8. Financial Literacy and Business Training

i. Develop training materials for digital entrepreneurs
ii. Conduct workshops on financial management and digital tax filing
iii. Partner with experts to deliver sessions
iv. Monitor training impact on business performance

9. Monitoring and Evaluation

i. Design an M&E framework for the SACCO
ii. Develop digital dashboards for data tracking
iii. Conduct periodic assessments and impact surveys
iv. Refine products and strategies based on feedback

10. Policy Advocacy and Engagement

i. Map key policy stakeholders
ii. Join and actively participate in national SACCO and innovation forums
iii. Draft policy briefs and recommendations
iv. Organize SACCO-led dialogues and tech-policy roundtables

SACCO IMPLEMENTATION SCHEDULE

ACTIVITY	DURATION IN QUARTERLY YEARS																			
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
SACCO Legal Formation and Regulatory Compliance																				
Digital SACCO Platform Development																				
Member Recruitment and Onboarding Campaign																				
Innovative Financial Products Design																				
Partnership Development and Fundraising																				
Innovation and Startup Mentorship Programs																				
Networking and Innovation Events																				
Financial Literacy and Business Development Training																				
Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E)																				
Policy Advocacy and Stakeholder Engagement																				

SACCO HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT PLAN

Staffing needs

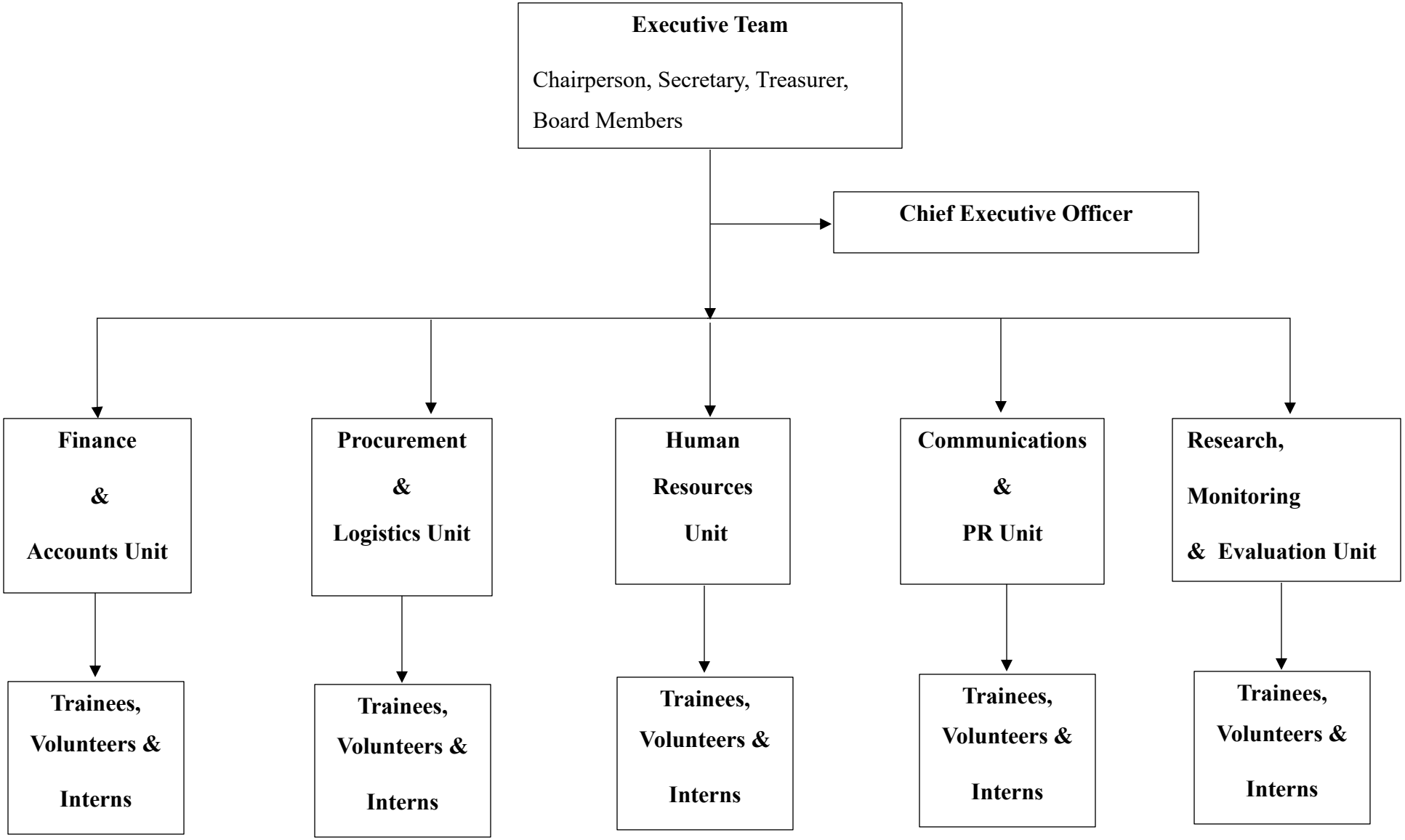
To successfully establish and operationalize UBUNIFU SACCO over the 5-year period (January 2026 – December 2031), the organization will require a professional and multi-skilled staff complement. The staff structure should support financial operations, governance, product development, technology infrastructure, member services, risk management, and growth of networks/partnerships.

Position / Department	Number of Staff	Key Qualifications & Experience	Core Responsibilities
Executive / Leadership Team	10	Bachelor's degree or higher in Finance, Business Administration, or related field. At least 7-10 years of experience in financial institutions (microfinance, SACCOs, banks) or startup financing; leadership experience; understanding of tech / creative sectors preferred.	Provide strategic direction, oversee operations, ensure compliance with laws/regulations, represent UBUNIFU SACCO in external partnerships, fundraising, stakeholder relations, policy, and governance.
Sacco Manager / CEO	1	Master's or Bachelor's plus strong track record in managing SACCOs, cooperatives or microfinance. Experience in credit, savings, investor relations.	Oversee daily operations; ensure the SACCO meets its financial & social objectives; manage senior staff; ensure sound governance; liaison with board and shareholders.
Finance & Accounting Department	8-12	Degrees in Accounting, Finance, or related field; CPA/ACCA or equivalent; familiarity with Uganda's	Manage accounts, budgeting, financial reporting, auditing, ensure statutory compliance (tax,

		financial regulatory environment; experience in SACCOs or MFIs/fintech.	cooperative law etc.), manage liquidity, interest calculations, share capital accounting.
Credit / Loans Department	23-35	Training in risk management, micro/SME lending; ability to assess startup and creative enterprise risk; experience with non-traditional collateral or alternative credit scoring; ideally, sector familiarity in tech and creative industries.	Product design and management for credit products; loan appraisal; monitoring and recovery; credit risk evaluations; managing delinquency; ensuring loans align with innovation/milestone metrics.
Member Services / Customer Relations	13-24	Strong customer service orientation; good communication skills; basic knowledge of financial products; experience with digital platforms; preferably multilingual (English + local languages).	Handle member onboarding; member support (queries, complaints, education); savings mobilization and awareness; promotional campaigns; training of members on products and digital tools.
Technology / IT & Innovation	8-13	Degrees or diplomas in Computer Science, IT, or related. Experience in fintech / software development, MIS, data security, mobile/web platforms; experience with integrating payments (mobile money, APIs etc.).	Set up and maintain the SACCO management system (MIS); develop mobile/web app for members; ensure cybersecurity and data protection; tech maintenance; lead innovation pilot projects; support digital service delivery.
Business Development / Partnerships / Innovation Support	5	Experience in startup ecosystems, incubation, innovation networks; knowledge of investment, grants, scaling; good networking and negotiation ability.	Identify, develop, and manage partnerships with innovation hubs, universities, investors; organize incubator programs or competitions; support members in grant access; foster networks; market intelligence.

Operations & Compliance / Risk Management	6-13	Strong background in internal audit, compliance, risk, legal/regulatory frameworks; cooperative law; knowledge of data protection, anti-money laundering (AML) etc.	Ensure compliance with cooperative law and financial regulations; internal audit; risk assessments; fraud prevention; policy drafting & enforcement; ensure sound operational processes and controls.
Communications, Marketing & Outreach	5	Training in communications, marketing or public relations; experience in digital marketing; understanding of creative/tech sectors; ability to design campaigns.	Develop branding, communications and marketing strategy; manage outreach to potential and existing members; digital / social media; run awareness campaigns; promote SACCO products; stakeholder communications.
Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning (MEL)	3-5	Experience in M&E in financial or development sector; ability to develop key performance indicators, baseline studies, impact measurement; data collection & analysis skills; preferably experience with technology startups/innovation metrics.	Design MEL framework; track performance of SACCO in terms of financial, social and innovation impact; gather feedback from members; periodic reporting; adapt services based on lessons learned.
Administrative & Support Staff	8-13	Diploma or certificate in business administration; good organizational, record-keeping and clerical skills; exposure to financial environment is a plus.	Front desk, clerical duties; file management; basic member documentation; scheduling; logistics for events and training; office management; ensuring smooth support services.

SACCO ORGANOGRAM



Motivation Plan for Staffing at UBUNIFU SACCO

To ensure the successful establishment and operation of UBUNIFU SACCO, it is imperative to recruit, retain, and motivate a dedicated team of professionals. The SACCO's mission; to empower tech startups, digital innovators, and creatives, requires not only competent staff but also one that is deeply inspired to drive innovation and community transformation. This motivation plan outlines strategies to attract, inspire, and retain talent within the SACCO structure.

1. Competitive and Performance-Based Remuneration

Drawing from research by Atukwatse & Turyamureeba (2024) on SACCOs in Mbarara, competitive salaries were noted as a fundamental motivator and a determinant of employee performance. UBUNIFU SACCO will implement a transparent salary scale aligned with market benchmarks, particularly for similar financial institutions and tech-oriented organizations. Additionally, a performance-based incentive system will be introduced. Staff who exceed targets; especially in mobilizing savings, loan recovery, or expanding digital access, will receive performance bonuses or recognition.

2. Professional Development and Capacity Building

A knowledgeable and empowered staff base is crucial, especially in the dynamic fintech and innovation sector. As highlighted by Noelin (2024), continuous learning is essential for SACCOs seeking to remain competitive and responsive to market demands. UBUNIFU SACCO will provide regular training, including:

- **i.** Workshops on financial technology tools and digital lending
- **ii.** Exposure visits to other successful innovation-based SACCOs
- **iii.** Certification opportunities in microfinance, digital banking, and cooperative governance

By investing in continuous learning, the SACCO not only motivates staff but also builds internal capacity to serve the unique needs of tech-driven members.

3. Innovation-Driven Culture and Intrinsic Motivation

Inspired by Bjornali & Ellingsen (2014), fostering a culture that encourages creativity and problem-solving within an organization enhances staff engagement, especially among young professionals. Given UBUNIFU's focus on startups and innovation, the SACCO will embrace

flexible working approaches and ideation platforms where employees can pitch new solutions to improve service delivery or financial inclusion. Staff whose ideas are implemented will receive recognition or monetary rewards.

4. Clear Career Growth Pathways

One of the critical de-motivators in many SACCOs, as revealed by Bosco & Moses (2023), is the lack of promotion opportunities. UBUNIFU SACCO will develop a clear and well-communicated internal promotion framework, enabling staff to grow from junior roles to managerial positions. Growth will be based on merit, skill development, and commitment to the SACCO's goals.

5. Supportive Work Environment and Welfare Packages

According to the work of Anania & Gikuri (2016), employee satisfaction is strongly linked to their perception of being valued and cared for by the institution. UBUNIFU SACCO will offer:

- **i.** Health insurance and wellness programs
- **ii.** Paid leave and family support policies
- **iii.** Periodic team-building retreats
- **iv.** Access to mental health and counseling support

Such welfare support enhances staff morale and fosters a sense of belonging, which is especially crucial in socially oriented finance institutions.

6. Use of Technology to Enhance Work Efficiency

To reduce burnout and improve staff motivation, UBUNIFU SACCO will deploy modern SACCO Management Information Systems (SMIS) as advised by Wanga (2025). Automating routine processes like loan tracking, member onboarding, and reporting will allow staff to focus on more value-added tasks such as member engagement, innovation support, and business advisory.

7. Recognition and Appreciation Culture

Small but meaningful recognitions go a long way. Staff will be acknowledged during monthly meetings for achievements, teamwork, or member service excellence. An annual staff awards program will also be instituted to celebrate innovation, leadership, and outstanding service delivery.

SACCO BUDGET

Fixed Capital Budget Allocation for Starting the SACCO

ACTIVITY	SUB TASK	ESTIMATED COST (UGX)
Registration and Legal Fees	Draft and approve SACCO by-laws	UGX 20,000,000
	Register with relevant national authorities	UGX 20,000,000
	Open institutional bank accounts	UGX 60,000,000
	Establish governance structures	UGX 80,000,000
Establish countrywide branches	Furniture	UGX 300,000,000
	Office Equipment	UGX 300,000,000
	Printers	UGX 160,000,000
	Technology and Software	UGX 80,000,000
Member Recruitment and Onboarding	Design branding and recruitment strategy	UGX 40,000,000
	Partner with universities, hubs, and associations	UGX 100,000,000
	Facilitate physical and digital registration of members	UGX 100,000,000
	Professional Fees	UGX 60,000,000
Financial Products Design	Conduct market needs assessments	UGX 50,000,000
	Initial Loan Reserves	UGX 240,000,000
	Reserve Fund	UGX 500,000,000
	Set interest rates and repayment schedules	UGX 20,000,000
Partnership Development and Fundraising	Identify potential funding partners	UGX 40,000,000
	Develop investment proposal documents	UGX 30,000,000
	Host donor/investor roundtables and forums	UGX 60,000,000
	Apply for innovation and cooperative grants	UGX 20,000,000

Mentorship and Acceleration Programs	Develop a mentorship curriculum	UGX 60,000,000
	Enroll mentors from tech and academia	UGX 60,000,000
	Match startups with mentors	UGX 40,000,000
	Monitor progress of mentored ventures	UGX 40,000,000
Marketing and Promotion	Organize quarterly SACCO tech summits	UGX 120,000,000
	Host national pitch days and demo showcases	UGX 80,000,000
	Create media partnerships for visibility	UGX 40,000,000
	Recognize top-performing startups	UGX 40,000,000
Financial Literacy and Business Training	Develop training materials	UGX 60,000,000
	Conduct workshops on financial management	UGX 80,000,000
	Partner with experts to deliver sessions	UGX 40,000,000
	Monitor training impact	UGX 20,000,000
Monitoring and Evaluation	Design an M&E framework	UGX 40,000,000
	Develop digital dashboards	UGX 60,000,000
	Conduct periodic assessments	UGX 40,000,000
	Refine products and strategies	UGX 20,000,000
Policy Advocacy and Engagement	Map key policy stakeholders	UGX 20,000,000
	Join innovation and SACCO forums	UGX 20,000,000
	Draft policy briefs and recommendations	UGX 20,000,000
	Organize dialogues and tech-policy roundtables	UGX 40,000,000
TOTAL		**3,220,000,000 UGX**

Operational Budget for First Year

Category	Sub-Activities / Description	Budget (UGX)
Feasibility Study & Needs Assessment	Baseline survey, SACCO demand analysis, data collection & research (Q2 2026)	48,000,000
Personnel & Staff Salaries	National & branch staff salaries for 1 year (Admin, Finance, IT, Marketing)	400,000,000
Operational Costs	Utilities, transport, communications, office supplies, member ID cards, share certificates	70,000,000
Digital Platform Maintenance & Support	Annual licensing, cloud hosting, cybersecurity, technical support for MIS	70,000,000
Marketing, Recruitment & Outreach	Member mobilization, media campaigns, branding, digital engagement, physical drives	50,000,000
Training & Capacity Building	Staff and member training on digital tools, SACCO MIS use, SACCO management	80,000,000
Maintenance Costs	Upkeep of office equipment and facilities. |	45,000,000
Loan Capital for Startups (Revolving Fund)	Initial capital for micro-loans, startup prototyping, early business scaling	900,000,000
Mentorship & Acceleration Programs	Program coordination, mentor incentives, startup support kits	35,000,000
Innovation Events & Networking	SACCO summits, pitch days, demo showcases, awards, media, logistics	20,000,000
Audit Costs	External auditing for compliance and transparency	12,000,000
Policy Engagement & Advocacy	Policy roundtables, forum participation, drafting briefs, engagement activities	50,000,000
TOTAL		**1,780,000,000**

SACCO SUSTAINABILITY PLAN

To ensure the long-term success and viability of the UBUNIFU SACCO, which is designed to support technology startups, digital innovators, and creatives across Uganda, a comprehensive sustainability strategy is essential. This plan outlines the core components that will guarantee environmental, financial, technical, governance, and community-level sustainability, even beyond initial donor and investor support.

i. **Environmental Sustainability:** While UBUNIFU SACCO operates within the digital economy, environmental sustainability remains relevant; especially in the development and deployment of digital infrastructure. The SACCO will adopt eco-friendly practices, such as promoting cloud-based systems to reduce paper usage and encouraging members to use virtual platforms for meetings and transactions. These digital-first strategies minimize travel-related carbon emissions and reduce the environmental impact of traditional banking operations. Partnerships with green-tech initiatives and climate-conscious enterprises will also be promoted, creating incentives for startups that incorporate sustainable technology solutions (Bjornali & Ellingsen, 2014).

ii. **Governance and Institutional Management:** Strong governance will be the bedrock of UBUNIFU SACCO's sustainability. A well-structured governance framework; comprising a Board of Directors, a Supervisory Committee, and a Credit Committee, will ensure transparency, accountability, and prudent financial management. Training for elected SACCO leaders and staff on cooperative principles, digital finance, and ethical governance will be continuous (Bosco & Moses, 2023). As highlighted by Benon et al. (2024), robust board accountability is directly linked to financial performance in SACCOs. Additionally, internal audits and third-party financial reviews will strengthen stakeholder trust and investor confidence. To mitigate governance-related risks, UBUNIFU SACCO will also establish clear conflict-of-interest policies and foster a democratic decision-making culture guided by member participation and annual general meetings (AGMs).

iii. **Continuity After Donor and Grant Withdrawa**l: To ensure continuity after the exit of donors or early-stage investors, UBUNIFU SACCO will build a self-sustaining business model. This includes the design of competitive financial products tailored for the innovation economy, such as prototype funding, revenue-based loans, and innovation acceleration loans. These products

will generate interest income and transaction fees that will finance the SACCO's operational needs. Member equity contributions, profit reinvestment, and internal capital mobilization strategies will form a reliable financial backbone. Moreover, as seen in successful SACCO models across Uganda, integrating digital platforms improves efficiency and member retention (Wanga, 2025). By gradually reducing reliance on external funding and building a diversified revenue portfolio, UBUNIFU SACCO can remain operational long-term.

iv. **Maintenance of Digital and Physical Infrastructure:** Digital infrastructure is central to UBUNIFU SACCO's operations. To maintain the SACCO's Management Information System (MIS), mobile banking platform, and data servers, the SACCO will allocate 5–10% of annual operating budgets toward digital infrastructure upkeep and upgrades. Technical staff will be trained to manage and troubleshoot these platforms to reduce dependence on external consultants (Wanga, 2025). A helpdesk support system will be maintained to serve members and troubleshoot user challenges. In addition, physical branches or regional service points will be strategically located in tech hubs, universities, and innovation centers. Maintenance costs of these branches will be co-financed through partnerships and rent-sharing agreements with incubators and local governments (Kamulegeya et al., 2017).

v. **Technical and Digital Sustainability:** The long-term functionality of UBUNIFU SACCO depends on its ability to adapt to changing technology and financial trends. Therefore, an in-house ICT team will be developed and trained continuously to manage the SACCO's digital tools and online services. Partnerships will be created with local universities and tech training institutions to offer internships and develop talent pipelines. A strong emphasis will be placed on digital literacy among members, especially creatives and startup founders who may lack exposure to financial management systems. Regular training sessions, webinars, and resource materials will be provided to keep the SACCO community informed and capable (Dickens et al., 2020).

vi. **Community Ownership and Participation:** Community and member engagement are critical to the SACCO's long-term relevance. UBUNIFU SACCO will foster a participatory culture by ensuring that members have access to voting rights, the opportunity to co-design products, and representation in governance committees. According to Anania & Gikuri (2016), SACCOs that meet members' expectations tend to achieve better retention, growth, and sustainability outcomes. Special outreach initiatives will target youth-led enterprises, women in tech, and

regional innovation groups to promote diversity and inclusion. Member feedback will be incorporated through regular surveys, suggestion platforms, and town-hall meetings. A rewards system will be implemented to recognize high-performing, compliant members, further incentivizing active participation.

vii. **Strategic Partnerships and Ecosystem Integration:** Long-term sustainability also hinges on the SACCO's ability to integrate into Uganda's broader innovation and financial ecosystem. Strategic partnerships will be formed with government institutions (e.g., Ministry of ICT, Uganda Investment Authority), private investors, development agencies, and regional innovation hubs to ensure continued financial and technical support (Kato & Chiloane-tsoka, 2022; Nuwagaba et al., 2021). UBUNIFU SACCO will also collaborate with academia to develop a research and development (R&D) wing that supports tech startups with business incubation, mentorship, and innovation grants, ensuring continual value addition beyond finance (Jjagwe et al., 2024).

viii. **Monitoring, Evaluation, and Adaptive Learning:** A digital monitoring and evaluation (M&E) system will be developed to assess the SACCO's financial performance, product uptake, member satisfaction, and social impact. Real-time dashboards, quarterly reports, and annual reviews will inform decision-making and allow for mid-course corrections. The SACCO will publish an annual impact report, promoting transparency and attracting further investor interest (Antonenko et al., 2014). Feedback from M&E will inform product development and strategy revisions, ensuring adaptability and resilience amidst a changing innovation landscape.

By embedding sustainability principles in governance, finance, infrastructure, and community engagement, UBUNIFU SACCO is well-positioned to serve as a transformative institution in Uganda's startup and creative economy. With solid foundations in digital systems, transparent leadership, and continuous stakeholder engagement, the SACCO will not only survive beyond donor cycles but thrive as a member-driven cooperative shaping the future of innovation and economic growth.

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